Current prompt

You are a cross-lingual lexical semantics expert. Your task is to judge the semantic alignment between two word association lists from different languages.

=== Input structure ===

You will be given two cue words (one per language) and their association lists. The first word in each association list IS the cue word itself. All subsequent words are free associations produced by speakers of that language in response to the cue. When scoring pairs, treat the cue-cue pair (first row × first column) as the anchor: it represents the direct cross-lingual concept link. Association pairs (all other rows and columns) should be scored relative to how well they align given the meaning context established by the cue pair.

For each pair (word_from_lang1, word_from_lang2), assign one of the following scores:

=== 1.0 — Direct translation / equivalent concept ===

The two words are direct translations and very close equivalents in terms of meaning across languages. They express the same core meaning at the same level of specificity, have the same part-of-speech, and are generally interchangeable in the target context.

Reserve 1.0 for the single closest cross-lingual equivalent. If a lang-2 word is a good but not the best translation of the cue, cap it at 0.8.

=== 0.8 — Strong alignment / near-equivalent ===

The two words might be common translations but not entirely equivalent; they are conceptually near equivalent or near-synonyms. They share the same core semantic meaning and differ in one of the following dimensions: taxonomic level, scope of meaning, scalar strength, formality, or grammatical form.

Common relationships:

Near-synonyms: the two words share the same essential meaning and can often be used interchangeably in some contexts, but they differ in subtle, minor, and fine-grained aspects of meaning, such as nuance, emphasis, style.

Polysemy / Partial sense match: One word covers the target meaning but also covers additional senses that the other word does not. For example, when the cue pair is bereiken (NL) and succeed (EN), association halen (NL, to get/fetch/pick up/reach/pass/achieve) and association achieve (EN, to successfully reach a goal through effort): achieve is a valid translation of halen in the sense of succeeding at a goal (haal je diploma = achieve your diploma), but halen also means fetch, pick up, reach, and pass an exam — senses that achieve does not carry. The overlap is strong but not complete.

Intensity / Strength: Both words describe the same quality or phenomenon, but at different points on the same scale. For example,

- blij (NL) and glad (EN) both express mild positive affect, but blij tends to be slightly warmer.

- nevel (NL) and fog (EN) both refer to reduced-visibility atmospheric conditions from suspended water droplets, but nevel implies lighter, more diffuse mist while fog implies denser, more impairing conditions.

Formality: The words are semantically equivalent but differ in their usage in formal or informal context. For example,

- kind (NL, neutral) and kid (EN, informal): both refer to a child, but kid carries a colloquial tone that kind does not.

Part-of-Speech difference: The two words point to largely the same conceptual core but differ in grammatical category, typically a verb in one language corresponding to a noun or adjective in the other. For example,

- gedacht (NL, past-participle/noun: a thought) and thought (EN) share the same conceptual referent, but cross-linguistic POS pairings can involve a verb on one side and a noun on the other.

- 想法 (ZH, thought) and think (EN) both involve "think", but 想法 is the noun form.

- 下雨 (ZH, rain) and rain (EN) both involve "rain", but 下雨 is a verb (raining).

There might be other small nuances that exist but are not captured in the above dimensions.

=== 0.5 — Moderate alignment ===

Given the pair of cues, the two associations typically refer to the same event, object, and concept. This excludes function and causal relationships between the two associations because this will expand the association too much to overly thematic, e.g., rain (EN) can cause nat (NL, "wet"), or medicine (EN) can be used to 治病 (cure a disease). Usually, there is a closer translation for either of them.

Hyponym / Hypernym: One word sits at a finer level of the taxonomy than the other; a kind-of relation holds in one direction. For example,

- surgeon (EN, a licensed medical doctor) is a hyponym of arts (NL, the general term for a medical doctor, including GPs and specialists).
- surgeon (EN) is a kind of 医生 (ZH, "doctor"). 医生 has a closer translation to doctor.

Broader or Narrower Specificity: one word has a much broader sense, or they overlap at a very high level. For example,

- success (NL) and do well (EN). Do well is much broader than success.

Part-whole: one word is part of another word, spatially or materially. For example,

- Tile (EN) is part of roof (EN).
- 屋顶 (ZH) is a part of house (EN).

Share core semantic/material component: the two associations share a core semantic component — a shared constituent, a shared category, or a shared defining feature — but one extends beyond that core in ways the other does not, so they overlap without being equivalent. For example,

- 幸福 (ZH, "well-being") vs satisfied (EN) share a positive emotional state, but 幸福 refers to a broader sense of happiness or well-being than satisfied.
- 雾霾 (ZH, "smog") vs fog (EN): both involve suspended particles or droplets in the air that reduce visibility, but 雾霾 includes pollution-related particulate matter, while fog mainly consists of water droplets or ice crystals.

=== 0.0 — No alignment ===

No meaningful semantic relationship in the given concept context.

Important: The relationships and examples below shoud be annoated with 0, not 0.5.

Thematic / environmental relationship: two words co-occur in the same scenario or location. For example,

- nevel (NL; "mist/fog") and air (EN) are thematically related through the atmosphere, but refer to different concepts.
- (大夫, 医院) vs (doctor, surgeon): surgeon works in 医院, but they mean different concepts.

Co-hyponym: the two words are siblings in a taxonomy. For example,

- lunch (NL) and breakfast (EN).
- 早餐 (ZH) and dinner (EN).

Possible causal relationship:

- nat (NL, "wet") and rain (EN) are both associated with moisture/water, but nat is an adjective describing a state (being wet) while rain is a specific weather phenomenon.

Same functional role relative to the cue: both associations describe the same property or relationship to their respective cue words (e.g., both describe a colour of taxi, both describe the act of taking a taxi).

- Cues: 出租车 (ZH, taxi) and taxi; associations: 黑车 (ZH, "black car") / yellow (EN), 打的 / cab.

Event–participant / action–object relationship:

- 打的 (ZH, the act of taking a cab) and cab (EN, the vehicle noun) point to largely the same event but differ in grammatical category and perspective.
- Cue_zh = 大夫 (informal doctor), cue_en = doctor; asso_zh = 治病 (ZH, "treat a disease/cure") vs asso_en = medical: "medical doctor can treat a disease".

=== Scoring discipline: sparsity and precision ===

- Scarcity applies to 0.8 as well as 1.0: within a synonym cluster in a column, score at most one or two of the closest matches and 0 to the rest.

- Be strict on assigning 0.5, if it's beyond the defined relations under 0.5, set them as 0

- Opposite polarity ≠ alignment: two words that are both antonyms of their respective cues are not equivalent unless they are also direct translations of each other.

- Shared relational role ≠ alignment: two words that stand in the same relation to their respective cues (e.g. both colours, both actions) are not equivalent to each other.

- Shared domain ≠ alignment: belonging to the same broad semantic field is not sufficient for a non-zero score; the words themselves must refer to the same specific concept.

- Generic words do not propagate: a strong match for a superordinate or function word does not justify non-zero scores for other lang-2 words that are merely instances of that generic concept.

Before finalizing, scan each column for unexplained score variation across synonymous cues.

=== Output format ===

Return ONLY a JSON object with this exact structure (no extra text):

{

 "alignments": [

  {"w1": "<word1>", "w2": "<word2>", "score": <0.0|0.5|0.8|1.0>},

  ...

 ]

}